

need Windows for your development environment. Android apps can be developed on any platform where Java JDK works well. iOS development demands that you have a Macintosh with Xcode installed.

► What IDE should I use?

Windows Phone asks for Visual Studio and iOS asks for XCode. Android being based on Java, can do with any IDE as long as you are able to compile the sources and generate an APK package. Ideally Eclipse is the IDE used by most but other IDEs with more features (such as IntelliJ Idea) too support Android SDKs.

► How much help would I get on the web?

iOS and Android cover majority of smartphone market and thus the help available on the web for one of these platforms is more than other platforms. Almost all platforms have well documented APIs which would help you as you progress.

► How much time is it going to take?

If you were to just throw the geographical coordinates on the user's screen, it would not take much time (and that does not count as AR). But if you were to include a map and an object recognition system right into your AR browser app, then you are going to have your hands dirty with code for a longer time. It would also depend on what your experience has been as a developer for your target platform.

As you can see, there are multiple variables in the mix and the most important factor which is going to affect your decision is the platform you want to target. Depending on the platform you want to build your app for, you



have several restrictions. Android NDK can be used to run platform specific code

As a side note, one of the biggest reasons Android wins the apps battle is the freedom of options it provides except in terms of programming language.

In all cases nonetheless, you are in need of the platform SDKs. In case of Android, you have a sepa-